

मसूरिका (Masurikā)

Introduction

Chicken Pox. The *Masurikā* is a disease which is signified as appearance of eruptions resembling *masūra* (lentils) in shape and size. Over-indulgence in eatables which are pungent, sour, salty, alkaline and are incompatible in nature and excess in quantity, irregular eating habits and fasting, intake of contaminated beans, leafy vegetables, air and water as well as bad planetary influences on certain areas of the country and in the community of people and like factors generate an increase of the *doṣās* in the body which subsequently in association with bad blood generate the above eruptions.

मसूरिका निदान एवं संप्राप्ति (Masurikā Nidāna Evam Samprāpti)

कट्वम्ललवणक्षारविरुद्धाध्यशनाशनैः ।
दुष्टनिष्पावशाकाद्यैः प्रदुष्टपवनोदकैः ॥
क्रूरग्रहेक्षणाच्चापि देशे दोषाः समुद्भूताः ।
जनयन्ति शरीरेऽस्मिन् दुष्टरक्तेन सङ्गताः ॥
मसूराकृतिसंस्थानाः पिडकाः स्युर्मसूरिकाः ।

M.Ni. 54/1-3

Causative factors for the development of *Masurikā* are as follows:— Due to excessive consumption of foods which are pungent, sour, alkaline; antagonistic foods & drinks; eating during indigestion; not eating food or less intake of food; regular consumption of contaminated *niṣpāva*, leafy vegetables, air & water; bad planetary influences of certain parts of the country.

मसूरिका संप्राप्ति (Masurikā Samprāpti)

Due to above etiological factors aggravation of *Doṣās* takes place. These aggravated *Doṣās* combined with polluted blood causes the development of skin eruptions which resemble like *Masūra* in size & shape is known as *Masurikā*.

Nidāna Sevana (Consumption of Etiological factors)



Aggravation of *Pittādi doṣās*



Diminution of *Agni*



Development of *Āma* inside the gastro intestinal tract



Excacerbated *doṣās* vitiates *Rakta*



Leading to development of skin eruptions



Masurikā

(Which resemble like *Masūra* in size & shape)

मसूरिका संप्राप्ति घटक (Samprāpti Ghaṭaka of Masurikā)

<i>Doṣa</i>	: <i>Tridoṣaja</i>
<i>Dūṣya</i>	: <i>Dhātu</i> → <i>Rakta, Rasa, Māmsa</i>
	<i>Upadhātu</i> → <i>Tvacā</i>
	<i>Śārīrika Mala</i> → <i>Puriṣa</i>
	<i>Dhātumala</i> → <i>Pitta, Kapha, Lasikā</i>
<i>Agni</i>	: <i>Jaṭharāgni, dhātvaṅni</i>
<i>Agniduṣṭi</i>	: <i>Mandāgni</i>
<i>Āma</i>	: <i>Agnijanya</i>
<i>Srotas</i>	: <i>Raktavaha, Rasavaha, Māmsavaha</i>
<i>Srotoduṣṭi</i>	: <i>Saṅga, Vimārgagamana</i>
<i>Adhiṣṭhāna</i>	: <i>Tvacā</i>
<i>Udbhavasthāna</i>	: <i>Āmāśayottha</i>
<i>Sancārasthāna</i>	: <i>Tvacā</i>
<i>Vyaktasthāna</i>	: <i>Tvacā</i>
<i>Prabhāva</i>	: <i>Rasagata (Tvag gata), Raktagata, Pittaja, Kaphaja & Kapha-</i>

pittaja are easily curable. *Vātajā*, *Vātapittajā*, *Kaphavātajā* are very difficult to cure. *Samipātajā* are incurable.

Svabhāva : *Āśukāri*
Roga bheda : 8 types based on *doṣa* involvement
 7 types based on *dhātu* involvement
Roga Mārga : *Bāhya*

पूरुवरूप (Pūrvarupa)

तासां पूरुवं ज्वरः कण्डूगर्भभङ्गोऽरतिर्भ्रमः ॥
 त्वचि शोथः सवैवर्ण्यो नेत्ररागश्च जायते ।

M.Ni. 54/3-4

Premonitory signs & symptoms of Masūrikā are as follows:—Fever, itching, pain all over the body, restlessness, giddiness, swelling & discoloration of skin and reddishness of eyes.

मसूरिका भेद (Masūrikā bheda)

Classification of Masūrikā

1. *Vātajā Masūrikā*
2. *Pittajā Masūrikā*
3. *Raktajā Masūrikā*
4. *Kaphajā Masūrikā*
5. *Tridoṣajā Masūrikā* (*Carma Pidakā*)
6. *Kapha-Pittajā Masūrikā* (*Romāntikā*)
7. *Vata-Pittajā Masūrikā*
8. *Kapha-Vātajā Masūrikā*

Another classification based on involvement of dhātus:—

1. *Tvak gata Masūrikā*
2. *Raktagata Masūrikā*
3. *Māmsagata Masūrikā*
4. *Medagata Masūrikā*
5. *Asthigata Masūrikā*
6. *Majjāgata Masūrikā*
7. *Śukragata Masūrikā*

वातज मसूरिका (Vātajā Masūrikā)

स्फोटाः श्यावारुणा रूक्षास्तीव्रवेदनयाऽन्विताः ॥
 कठिनाश्चिरपाकाश्च भवन्त्यनिलसंभवाः ।

सन्ध्यस्थिपर्वणां भेदः कासः कम्पोऽरतिः क्लमः ॥
 शोषस्तात्त्वोष्ठजिह्वानां तृष्णा चारुचिसंयुता ।

M.Ni. 54/4-6

Vātajā Masūrikā is characterised by skin eruptions which are black, rough, severe pain, hard, delayed suppuration, pain in joints, bones & small joints, cough, tremors, restlessness, exhaustion, dryness of the palate, lips & tongue; thirst and anorexia.

पित्तज मसूरिका (Pittajā Masūrikā)

रक्ताः पीतसिताः स्फोटाः सदाहास्तीव्रवेदनाः ॥
 भवन्त्यचिरपाकाश्च पित्तकोपसमुद्भवाः ।
 विड्भेदश्चाङ्गमर्दश्च दाहस्तृष्णाऽरुचिस्तथा ॥
 मुखपाकोऽक्षिरागश्च ज्वरस्तीव्रः सुदारुणः ।

M.Ni. 54/6-8

Pittajā Masūrikā is characterised by skin eruptions which are red, yellow, associated with severe burning sensation & pain, quick suppuration, diarrhoea, general malaise, burning sensation, thirst, loss of appetite, stomatitis, redness of eyes, severe fever & very difficult for management.

रक्तज मसूरिका (Raktajā Masūrikā)

रक्तजायां भवन्त्येते विकाराः पित्तलक्षणाः ॥

M.Ni. 54/8

Raktajā Masūrikā is characterised by signs & symptoms similar to those of *Pittajā Masūrikā* are seen.

कफज मसूरिका (Kaphajā Masūrikā)

कफप्रसेकः स्रैमित्यं शिरोरुग्गात्रगौरवम् ।
 हृत्लासः सारुचिर्निद्रा तन्द्रालस्यसमन्विताः ॥
 श्वेताः स्निग्धा भृशं स्थूलाः कण्डूवरा मन्दवेदनाः ।
 मसूरिकाः कफोत्थाश्च चिरपाकाः प्रकीर्तिताः ॥

M.Ni. 54/9-10

Kaphajā Masūrikā is characterised by *Kaphapraseka*, stiffness, headache, heaviness, nausea, loss of appetite, sleep, stupor, lassitude, associated with skin eruptions which are white, soft, big, itching, mild pain and suppurates slowly.

त्रिदोषज मसूरिका/चर्मपिडका (Tridoṣajā Masūrikā/ Carmapidakā)

नीलाश्चिपिटविस्तीर्णा मध्ये निम्ना महारुजः ।
 चिरपाकाः पूतिस्त्रावाः प्रभूताः सर्वदोषजाः ॥

कण्ठरोधारुचिस्तम्भप्रलापारतिसंयुताः ।
दुश्चिकित्स्याः समुद्दिष्टाः पिडकाश्चर्मसंज्ञिताः ॥

M.Ni. 54/11-12

Tridoṣaja Masūrika or *Carmapiḍakā* is characterised by skin eruptions which are blue, flat, broad, depressed at the centre, severe painful, suppurating slowly, exudes pus which is foul smelling & large in quantity; obstruction in the throat, loss of appetite, stiffness, delirium, & restlessness is known as *Carmapiḍakā* & manifest due to involvement of all the three *Doṣās* & difficult to treat.

कफपित्तज मसूरिका/रोमान्तिका (Kapha-Pittaja Masūrikā/Romāntikā)

Kaphapittaja Masūrikā or *Romāntikā* characterised by skin eruptions which are small, red at the roots of the hairs making slight elevation associated with cough, loss of appetite and fever.

धातुगत मसूरिका (Dhātugata Masūrika)

त्वक्गत मसूरिका (Tvakgata Masūrikā) or रसगत मसूरिका (Rasagata Masūrikā)

तोयबुद्बुदसङ्काशास्त्वग्गतास्तु मसूरिका ।
स्वल्पदोषाः प्रजायन्ते भिन्नास्तोयं स्रवन्ति च ॥

M.Ni. 54/14

Tvakgata Masūrikā is characterised by skin eruptions which resembles like bubbles of water, exudes thin watery fluid on pricking associated with signs & symptoms of *Doṣās* which are mild in nature.

रक्तज मसूरिका (Raktaja Masūrikā)

रक्तस्था लोहिताकाराः शीघ्रपाकास्तनुत्वचः ।
साध्या नात्यर्थदुष्टाश्च भिन्ना रक्तं स्रवन्ति च ॥

M.Ni. 54/15

Raktaja Masūrikā is characterised by skin eruptions which are red, suppurates quickly, thin skin, bleeds quickly after pricking and it is very difficult to treat.

मांसज मसूरिका (Māmsaja Masūrikā)

मांसस्थाः कठिनाः स्निग्धाश्चिरपाका घनत्वचः ।
गात्रशूलतृषाकण्डूज्वरारतिसमन्विताः ॥

M.Ni. 54/16

Māmsaja Masūrikā is characterised by skin eruptions which are hard, slimy, suppurates slowly, thick skin, associated with pain all over the body, thirst, itching, fever & restlessness.

मेदज मसूरिका (Medaja Masūrikā)

मेदोजा मण्डलाकारा मृदवः किञ्चिदुन्नताः ।
घोरज्वरपरीताश्च स्थूलाः स्निग्धाः सवेदनाः ॥
संमोहारतिसंतापाः कश्चिदाभ्यो विनिस्तरेत् ।

M.Ni. 54/17-18

Medaja Masūrikā is characterised by skin eruptions which are round, soft, slightly elevated, big, slimy, painful, high grade fever, delusion, restlessness, distress & only few persons get rid off this condition.

अस्थिमज्जागत मसूरिका (Asthi-Majjāgata Masūrikā)

क्षुद्रा गात्रसमा रूक्षाश्चिपिटाः किञ्चिदुन्नताः ॥
मज्जोत्था भृशसंमोहवेदनारतिसंयुताः ।
छिन्दन्ति मर्मधामानि प्राणानाशु हरन्ति हि ॥
भ्रमरेणेव विद्धानि कुर्वन्त्यस्थीनि सर्वतः ।

M.Ni. 54/18-20

Asthi-Majjāgata Masūrikā is characterised by skin eruptions which are small, of the same level of skin, rough, flat, slightly elevated, associated with severe delusion, pain, restlessness, cutting pain in vital organs, takes away the life and severe pain in the bones as though stung by bees.

शुक्रगत मसूरिका (Śukragata Masūrikā)

पक्वाभाः पिडकाः स्निग्धाः सूक्ष्माश्चात्यर्थवेदनाः ॥
स्तैमित्यारतिसंमोहदाहोन्मादसमन्विताः ।
शुक्रजायां मसूर्या तु लक्षणानि भवन्ति हि ॥
निर्दिष्टं केवलं चिह्नं दृश्यते न तु जीवितम् ।

M.Ni. 54/20-22

Śukragata Masūrikā is characterised by skin eruptions which are ripe, slimy, minute, severe pain associated with stiffness, restlessness, delusion, burning sensation, toxicity and patient death is certain.

Involvement of *Doṣās* in *Dhātugata Masūrikā*.

दोषमिश्रास्तु सप्तैता द्रष्टव्या दोषलक्षणैः ॥

M.Ni. 54/22

In all seven varieties of *Masūrikā* i.e.

Dhātugata Masūrikā signs & symptoms of one or two or three *Doṣās* are to be seen.

साध्यासाध्याता (Sādhyāsādhyatā)

त्वग्गता रक्तजाश्च पित्तजाः श्लेष्मजास्तथा ।
श्लेष्मपित्तकृताश्च सुखसाध्या मसूरिकाः ॥
वातजा वातपित्तोत्थाः श्लेष्मवातकृताश्च याः ।
कृच्छ्रसाध्यतमास्तस्माद्यत्नादेता उपाचरेत् ॥
असाध्याः सन्निपातोत्थास्तासां वक्ष्यामि लक्षणम् ।
प्रवालसदृशाः कश्चित् काश्चिज्जम्बूफलोपमाः ॥
लोहजालसमाः काश्चिदतसीफलसन्निभाः ।
आसां बहुविधा वर्णा जायन्ते दोषभेदतः ॥

M.Ni. 54/23-26

Rasagata (Tvag gata), *Raktagata*, *Pittaja*, *Kaphaja* & *Kapha-pittaja* are easily curable. *Vātajā*, *Vātapittaja*, *Kaphavātajā* are very difficult to cure, these *Masūrikā* should be treated with great effort & care.

Sannipātaja are incurable. Signs & symptoms of *Sannipātaja* are development of skin eruptions which resemble either colour of coral beads or fruits of *Jambū* or like an iron sieve or like fruits of *Atasi* and many such colours develops due to combination of *Doṣās*.

अरिष्ट लक्षण (Ariṣṭa Lakṣaṇa)

कासो हिक्का प्रमेहश्च ज्वरस्तीव्रः सुदारुणः ।
प्रलापश्चारतिर्मूर्च्छा तृष्णा दाहोऽतिघूर्णता ॥
मुखेन प्रस्रवेद्रक्तं तथा घ्राणेन चक्षुषा ।
कण्ठे घुर्घुरकं कृत्वा श्वसित्यत्यर्थवेदनम् ॥
मसूरिकाभिभूतस्य यस्यैतानि भिषग्वरैः ।
लक्षणानि च दृश्यन्ते न दद्यादत्र भेषजम् ॥
मसूरिकाभिभूतो यो भृशं घ्राणेन निःश्वसेत् ।
स भृशं त्यजति प्राणास्तृषार्तो वायुदूषितः ॥
मसूरिकान्ते शोथः स्यात् कूपरे मणिवन्धके ।
तथाऽसफलके चापि दुश्चिकित्स्यः सुदारुणः ॥

M.Ni. 54/27-30

If following signs & symptoms observed in *Masūrika* patients, then it should not be considered for treatment.

Cough, hiccough, *Prameha*, high fever, delirium, restlessness, fainting, thirst, burning sensation, curvatures of the body, bleeding from mouth, nose & eyes; wheezing sound in the throat, breathes with great difficulty. One who is breathing

only expiration through nose, thirst & observation of vitiated symptoms of *Vāta* are indicative of death of the patient. Profound swelling in the elbow, wrist & shoulder joints develop in the last stage of *Masūrikā* and it is not possible to treat.

उपशय/पथ्य (Upaśaya/Pathya)

If the eruptions had become quite mature one should not try to treat the same as they are dried by wind itself. If a drug is administered at this stage it may vitiate the *Vāta doṣa*. As a result the poisons of *Masūrikā* would circulate inside the body itself. Therefore, it is better to support the *Vāta doṣa* of the body. For this purpose, one should take the *Rasāyanas* and the nutritious meals. (B.R. 59/15)

The patient of *Masūrikā* first go through *Vamana* (emetic) therapy, *Virecana* (purgation) therapy, blood letting and the like. After that, he should be served with the following eatables: old rice of *Śāli* variety, grams, *Mudga* beans, lentil beans, barley, meat of *Pratuda* birds (those who take their meals through beaks like pigeon, sparrow, *Krouñca*, parrot and the like), *Paṭola*, *Kāravellaka*, fruits of rainy season, banana fruits, drumsticks, *Mātulunga* lemon, *Drākṣā*, pomegranate and the like nutritious items. To treat eyes one should wash them with water treated with the *Gavedhu* and *Madhuka* herbs, camphor powder and drops obtained from conch shells. When the eruptions are matured one should take pulse soup of *Mudga* beans, meat soup of wild animals, leaves of *Śāli* plant, *Ghṛtam*, leaves of *Nirguṇḍī* plant and the like. The patient should take smoke (*Dhūpana*) therapy by burning *Gomaya* and *Guggulu*. If the eruptions are containing pus the patient should rub his body with ash of burnt reeds. He should also coat his body with *Kalka* of dried *Nimba* leaves and *Haridrā*. One could even treat the eruptions in manner sores are treated. The patient could also take appropriate decisions as per the guidelines above. It helps to make one comfortable in that disease. (B.R. 59/68-71)

अनुपशय/अपथ्य (Anupaśaya/Apathya)

The patient of *Masūrikā* should avoid the

following: Intercourse, *Svedana* (fomentation), excessive labour, getting angry, taking contaminated water and polluted air, suppression of natural urges and the like. He should also not take oily edibles, meals that are heavy to digest, bitter and citrus in taste. (B.R. 59/72-73)

रोमान्तिका (Romāntika)

रोमावूपोन्नतिसमा रागिण्यः कफपित्तजाः ।
कासारोचकसम्बुक्ता रोमान्त्यो ज्वरपूर्विकाः ॥

(M.Ni. Uttā. 54/13)

Romantika is characterized by eruptions in the skin and it arises at the root of hair follicles with slight elevation associated with red in colour, cough and loss of appetite. It is caused due to

Kapha and *Pitta doṣa*. The disease will be always preceded by fever.

मसूरिकायाः प्रकारं रोमान्तिकामाह-रोमकूपोन्नतिसमा इत्यादि ।
रागिण्य इति लोहिताः, ज्वरपूर्विका इति ज्वरपूर्वहृपाः ॥ (मधुकोश
व्याख्या)

According to *Madhukoṣa* commentary.

मसूरिकायाः प्रकारं रोमान्तिकामाह:- It is a variety of
masūrikā

रोमकूपोन्नतिसमा इत्यादितः- Elevated eruptions at the
root of hair follicle.

रागिण्य इति लोहिताः- Red in colour

ज्वरपूर्विका इति ज्वरपूर्वहृपाः- Associated with
manifestation of *jvara* as *pūrvārūpa*.